

advanced connoisseurs were prone to dismiss his late string quartets, which were composed in the midst of terminal illness in 1825–1826, as incomprehensible. Nonetheless, these quartets would later come to be recognized as prophetic works of supreme power and invention.

After a long illness, Beethoven died in Vienna in March 1827. His funeral was attended by some 20,000 people. In an oration at Währing Cemetery, poet Franz Grillparzer said: “He whom you mourn is now among the greatest men of all time, unassailable for ever.”



BEETHOVEN'S FUNERAL

Thousands of admirers lined the streets of Vienna at the composer's funeral. Famous musicians, including Franz Schubert and Carl Czerny, served as pallbearers.